

Todd Takala

Lead Data Scientist — Lead Machine Learning Engineer — AI/ML Engineer — Remote

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Professional Summary

Lead Data Scientist with a proven track record of delivering over \$1.3 billion in business value through machine learning and end-to-end data science solutions to solve complex challenges. Manage complete project lifecycle, including stakeholder engagement, KPI definition, development, and deployment.

Education

Bachelor of Science in Mechanical Engineering — Arizona State University — Tempe, AZ 2006

STEM coursework included:

- Computational Thermodynamics, Design of Experiments (DoE), Differential Equations, Economics, Finance, Finite Element Analysis, Linear Algebra, Logic, Manufacturing, Material Science, Multivariate Calculus, Numerical Methods, Statistics

Experience

Lead Data Scientist

Sept 2022 – Present

Caterpillar Inc. — Surprise, AZ

- Led the end-to-end development of high-impact data science initiatives, including an award-winning ML system to predict equipment repair times. Engineered and deployed robust MLOps pipelines using AWS and Snowflake and established best practices for CI/CD and system architecture. Managed project lifecycles and created comprehensive monitoring plans to validate business impact.
- Engineered and deployed robust ETL/MLOps pipelines using Snowflake and AWS services (SageMaker, S3, Step Functions) to automate model retraining. Championed MLOps best practices, setting new standards for GitHub CI/CD, Docker, and AWS architecture.
- Spearheaded the creation of an ML/AI system to predict equipment repair times, resulting in an \$80 million reduction in warranty costs and a CEO Award.

Reliability Analytics Manager

Feb 2022 – Sept 2022

Amazon — Tempe, AZ

- Pioneered a new design-for-reliability benchmark by analyzing petabyte-scale IoT data from a large robotics fleet. Authored an influential white paper on complex Weibull analysis and secured adoption of the new benchmark by senior leadership.
- Analyzed over 2 petabytes of IoT data from a 400,000-robot fleet to establish a new design-for-reliability benchmark.
- Designed and optimized winning regression and recommendation systems, achieving two-time champion status in the Amazon Machine Learning University competition.

Data Engineering Manager

Empire-Cat — Mesa, AZ

Jan 2012 – Feb 2022

- Created a artificial intelligence model for engine reliability, durability, repair, preventive maintenance and intervention leading to \$62 million in savings within 90 days.
- Led a team to establish an MLOps pipeline with ARIMA and SVM for AI-driven forecasting in supply chain management, integrated data, managed a component exchange program, collaborated with clients on durability forecasting, and addressed design flaws in mining equipment, reducing client costs by \$1.2B. This involved creating a comprehensive machine learning dataset from NLP on work orders and IoT telemetry.
- Directed a high-performance team of up to 8 engineers, fostering a data-driven approach to solve equipment performance issues as Reliability Engineering Manager before being promoted. Resolved critical design flaws in mining equipment through reproducible analysis in R and SQL, saving clients \$1.2 billion over six years.

Certifications

Arizona State Board of Technical Registration EIT, Mechanical Engineering, Registration No. 10670

BerkeleyX The Science of Happiness at Work Professional Certificate

Canonical Ubuntu Linux Professional Certificate

CSCMP Supply Chain Foundations Demand Planning Professional Certificate

Data Camp AI Fundamentals Certificate, Certified SQL Associate, Data Scientist Professional Certificate

Empire-Cat Business Tools for Service Managers, Coaching for Peak Performance, Communicating for Leadership Success, Delegating with Purpose, Lean 6 Sigma Green Belt, Resolving Workplace Conflict, Setting Performance Expectations

GitHub Career Essentials in GitHub Professional Certificate

IUOE Local 150 Diesel Mechanic, Heavy Equipment Operator (Bulldozers, Class B CDL, Cranes, Forklifts, MSHA, Preventive Maintenance, Scrapers, Skid-steers, Telehandlers, Wheel Loaders) Shielded Metal Arc Welding (SMAW)

Komatsu North America Certified Technical Communicator

Society of Automotive Engineers Cost and Finance for Engineers

Udemy Streamlit for Snowflake Masterclass

Skills

AI/ML, Agile, Anomaly Detection, Architectural Design, Artificial Intelligence, AWS (ECR, Event Bridge, Redshift, Sagemaker, Step Functions), Business Requirements, Coaching, Continuous Integration, Creative, Database Administrator, Data Gathering, DBA, Deep Learning, DevOps, Developer Tools, Distributed Computing, Docker, Embedding, ETL, Git, GitHub Actions, GitHub Copilot, Growth Mindset, LLMs, Large Language Models, Mentoring, Problem Solving, Python (Autogluon, keras, numpy, pandas, PyTorch, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow), R (dplyr, prophet, tidyverse), Research, Snowflake, SQL, Streamlit, Statistical Tools, Strategic Thinking, Adaptability, Transformers, Willing to Learn